



HOW TO FIRE THE CLAY

- ✿ To fire your metal clay you will need to be in a well-ventilated, dimly lit room.
- ✿ Have a dish of water, metal tweezers, and a timer at hand.
- ✿ You will see a small flame and smoke as the organic binder burns away; this will only last a few seconds.
- ✿ The clay will start to glow a peachy-orange colour; you need to maintain this colour for two minutes.
- ✿ If it starts to glow bright red or shiny silver, it is too hot, so move the flame away slightly.

10 Place the heart charm on a ceramic tile or firing brick, on a heatproof surface. Set the timer for two minutes. Hold the blowtorch about 5cm (2in) from the clay and move the flame evenly over the charm. You will see a small flame and smoke, then the clay will start to glow a peach colour. Once it starts to glow, start the timer and continue firing.



11 When the two minutes are up, either leave the charm to cool on the tile or carefully lift it with the tweezers and place it in a dish of cold water. The heart will now be a matt-white colour, even though it is made of pure silver.



12 Before polishing the charm, you must patinate it to highlight the fingerprint and the stars. Put a couple of drops of the liver of sulphur in hot, but not boiling, water. Then, using tweezers, place the charm in the solution. The silver will quickly turn black. Once it is completely black, use the tweezers to remove it, then wash it in clean water and dry it.